Getting Past the Gatekeeper

One Wealth Map RIA outreach

Each situation has a goal, a sample response and the reason behind it. Use the samples as a guide. You can adjust the wording so it sounds natural, but keep every fact and claim exactly as approved.

Know your goal

With a gatekeeper: **get connected**. With the owner: **book the meeting**.

Leave with something

Try to end each call with a **transfer**, a **callback time**, a **direct line**, or an **email**.

Keep it short

Your answer to a gatekeeper should be one or two sentences. Long answers sound like a sales call.

START HERE Think of the gatekeeper as a building guard

A guard lets people in when they give a name and a clear reason. When someone starts explaining products, the guard usually stops them at the lobby. Gatekeepers work the same way.

A simple pattern to follow:

Answer	→	Add	→	Request	→	Polite
Reply to their question first		One line of context, no pitch		"Could you put me through?"		Please and thank you

Why end with a request: "Could you put me through, please? Thank you." is polite, and it expects a yes. "Is [Owner] available?" makes it easy to say no. Only ask about times when the owner is truly not available.

Sound sure: say it calmly, like you expect to be connected. If you lose your words, breathe and go back to one line: "I'm calling on behalf of our founder, Ken Himmler, about [Owner]'s practice."

Always be honest

Be confident, but **only say what's true**. Use your real name, the same way, on every call and follow-up. Don't say it's a follow-up call if it isn't. You can say you're calling on behalf of our founder, Ken Himmler. Don't say Ken knows the owner, asked you to call them, wants to meet them, or came across their practice. Client call reviews have flagged these lines. Don't pretend to know the owner. Only use approved firm facts: a multi-family office, around $300 million, growing about 40% a year, and a founder who has built and sold a few firms. These calls can be recorded, and the firms we call are regulated. Honesty protects you, the client and One Wealth Map.

Before and after every call

Before you dial: check GHL and the lead source. Know if it's a firm owner or an individual advisor. Ask for the exact name in the GHL record.
Never say to a gatekeeper: anything about selling, buying, merging or recruiting, any numbers, or who else we're talking to. Owner conversations are confidential.
If someone asks to be removed: mark Do Not Call in GHL right away, before your next dial.
In the samples: [Owner] is the person you're trying to reach. Use their first name.

WORDS With gatekeepers: words that help, words to avoid

These help

- **"It's about [Owner]'s practice"** is clear and true
- **"Calling on behalf of our founder, Ken Himmler"** gives a real reason
- **"One Wealth Map"** plus your real name says clearly who is calling
- **The owner's first name** shows you did your research
- **"Please" and "thank you"** keep it respectful
- **"Could you put me through, please?"** is polite and expects a yes

Avoid these

- **"Is [Owner] available?"**, **"Is now a good time?"** or **"Can I ask you a quick question?"** make it easy to say no
- **"Opportunity"** or **"potential"** sound like a sales call
- **"Offer," "services," "AI," "grow faster"** also sound like a sales call
- **A long company description** (location, type of firm) when they didn't ask
- **"Sorry to bother you"** at the start makes the call sound unimportant
- **Trailing off** mid-sentence makes it harder to finish your point
- **"Ken asked me to connect with you," "Ken wants to meet you," "came across your practice"** or **"Ken is expecting your call"** are not approved, so don't say them
- Repeating **"business matter"** again and again sounds like you're hiding something
- **"More leads than we can handle"** or any figure that is not approved

A Screening questions

The gatekeeper is checking who you are and why you're calling.

#	Situation	Goal	Why it works
1	**"What's this regarding?"**	Answer, then add one line of context. Then ask to be connected.	**Like telling a guard "I'm here to see Mr. Reyes about his account."** One clear reason sounds professional. Just "business matter" invites more questions.
	Sample: "It's about [Owner]'s advisory practice and some longer-term business plans. I'm calling on behalf of our founder, Ken Himmler, and it's best discussed with [Owner] directly. Could you put me through, please? Thank you."		
2	**"Is this a sales call?"**	Answer calmly in one line. Give the real reason, then ask to be connected.	**Like a guard asking "Delivery?"** A calm, clear reason sounds like a visitor, not a vendor.
	Sample: "It's not a sales pitch. I'm calling on behalf of our founder, Ken Himmler, about [Owner]'s practice. Could you put me through, please? Thank you."		
3	**"Where are you calling from?"**	Company name, plus who you're calling for. Then ask again.	**Like a name tag with a reason.** It says who you are and why you're there, in one line.
	Sample: "One Wealth Map. I'm calling on behalf of our founder, Ken Himmler, for [Owner]. Could you put me through, please? Thank you."		
4	**"Is [Owner] expecting your call?" / "Do you have an appointment?"**	Say no with confidence. Then give the reason and ask again. Don't stop at "no."	**Like walking up without a reservation.** Restaurants still seat you if you ask confidently: "No reservation, is a table free now?"
	Sample: "No, [Owner] isn't expecting my call. I'm calling on behalf of our founder, Ken Himmler. It's about [Owner]'s practice. Could you put me through, please? Thank you."		
5	**"Does the owner know you?"**	Be honest. Then give the reason and ask again.	**Like a new neighbor knocking.** You don't pretend to be a relative. Being honest keeps their trust.
	Sample: "Not yet. I'm calling on behalf of our founder, Ken Himmler, about [Owner]'s practice. Could you put me through, please? Thank you."		
6	**"How did you get this number?"**	Briefly share the real source, without overexplaining. If you don't know, don't guess.	**Like a shop asked how it got your address.** A clear answer calms people. Avoiding the question can feel suspicious.
	Sample: "Our team came across your firm through our research. I'm calling on behalf of our founder, Ken Himmler, about [Owner]'s practice. Could you put me through, please? Thank you."		

#	Situation	Goal	Why it works
7	**"Can I tell them what it's about?"**	Give a short, credible reason they can pass on to the owner. Then redirect to availability.	**Like a sealed letter.** The secretary delivers it but doesn't open it. A short, clear reason is easy to pass on.
	Sample: "Sure. It's [Your name] from One Wealth Map, calling on behalf of our founder, Ken Himmler, about [Owner]'s practice. Could you put me through, please? Thank you."		
8	**"Who's Ken?"**	One line on who Ken is. Then ask again.	**Like saying whose guest you are.** A real name and role makes the reason clear.
	Sample: "Ken Himmler is the founder of One Wealth Map. I'm calling on his behalf about [Owner]'s practice. Could you put me through, please? Thank you."		
9	**They keep asking for more details.**	Stay calm. Say the same reason in different words. Don't pitch, and don't mention AI, leads or services.	**Like a movie trailer.** Enough to show it's worth it. The full story is for the owner.
	Sample: "I understand. We're a registered investment adviser, and this is about [Owner]'s practice. It's best discussed with [Owner] directly. Could you put me through, please? Thank you."		
10	**"Are you with [their firm]?" / "Are you approved by our broker-dealer?"**	Give a clear, honest no. Then redirect.	**Like being asked "Are you from the bank?"** A clear "No" builds trust. A vague answer can sound like a connection that doesn't exist.
	Sample: "No, we're an independent RIA, not affiliated with [firm name]. I'm calling on behalf of our founder, Ken Himmler, about [Owner]'s practice. Could you put me through, please? Thank you."		

B Owner not available

When the owner is busy, find out the best time to call back.

#	Situation	Goal	Why it works
11	**"They're with a client / in a meeting."**	They are truly not available, so now it's okay to get a time. Ask, don't guess. Log it in GHL.	**Like a doctor in surgery.** You ask the nurse what time they'll be out. "Later" isn't a time.
	Sample: "That's fine. Since you have [Owner]'s calendar, what time today is best to reach them?"		
12	**"They're out this week."**	Find the day they're back.	**Like a store closed for the holidays.** You check the reopening date instead of guessing.
	Sample: "Thanks for letting me know. What day are they back? I'll call then."		

#	Situation	Goal	Why it works
13	**"They're busy all day, every day."**	Find a gap: early or late.	**Like catching a busy professor.** Not during class. Before the first or after the last.
	Sample: "Understood. What time does [Owner] usually start their day?"		
14	**"Everything goes through me."**	Make the gatekeeper your partner.	**Like a barangay hall.** Follow their process and the secretary helps you. Fight it, and nothing moves.
	Sample: Thank you, I appreciate your help. I'm calling on behalf of our founder, Ken Himmler, about [Owner]'s practice. What's the best way to reach them?		

C Brush-offs

Say yes to their request, then ask for one more detail.

#	Situation	Goal	Why it works
15	**"If they're interested, they'll call you back."**	Don't wait for them. Ask for a direct line or the best time.	**Like "we'll text you" after a job interview.** You may not hear back. Setting the next step yourself helps.
	Sample: "I understand. Since it's about [Owner]'s practice, it's best to talk directly. What's the best direct line for [Owner]?"		
16	**"Send an email."**	Say yes, then ask for a direct email or a time.	**Like "leave it at the front desk."** It may sit in a pile. A direct address gives it a real chance.
	Sample: "Happy to. What's [Owner]'s direct email, so it reaches them directly?"		
17	**"Send it to info@."**	Avoid the general inbox.	**Like a box marked "General."** It might never get opened.
	Sample: "Sure. What's [Owner]'s direct email? It's about their practice, so I'd like it to reach them directly."		
18	**"Leave a message."**	Leave it short, and set your own follow-up.	**Like ordering food and waiting forever.** Follow up yourself, or it may never come.
	Sample: "Sure. Please let them know [Your name] from One Wealth Map called. What's the best direct line or email to reach [Owner]?"		
19	**"Just leave a voicemail."**	Keep it under 20 seconds. Name, company, a short reason, and your number twice.	**Like a text vs. a long letter.** People finish short messages. Say your number slowly, twice.
	Simple version: Hi [Owner], this is [Your name] from One Wealth Map. I'm calling on behalf of our founder, Ken Himmler, about your practice. Please call me back at [number]. Again, that's [Your name], [number].		

#	Situation	Goal	Why it works
20	**"We get calls like this all the time."**	Show respect. Keep the ask tiny.	**Like asking a busy cashier for one quick thing.** A short, polite request is easy to say yes to.
	Sample: "I understand, and I'll keep it short. What time today is best to reach [Owner]?"		

D When the gatekeeper decides

Stay polite and let the owner make the decision.

#	Situation	Goal	Why it works
21	**"They're not interested." (for the owner)**	Don't argue and don't pitch. Let the owner decide.	**Like a helper saying "Ma'am doesn't want it."** Ma'am never saw it.
	Sample: "I understand. Since it's about [Owner]'s practice, it's best if [Owner] decides. Could you put me through, please? Thank you."		
22	**"I handle these decisions."**	Find out kindly if they're an owner or staff.	**Like a barangay captain's secretary.** They schedule, but only the captain signs.
	Sample: "Thank you. Are you part of the ownership, or do you help manage operations?"		
23	**"We already have an advisor." / "We don't need services."**	Acknowledge their current setup. Clarify the call isn't about replacing their advisor or selling services. Redirect to the owner.	**Like a tutor turned away because "the kids have a teacher."** You're there for the school owner, not the kids.
	Sample: "That's great that you have a setup that works. This isn't about replacing anyone. I'm calling on behalf of our founder, Ken Himmler, about [Owner]'s practice. Could you put me through, please? Thank you."		
24	**"We're not hiring." / "We're not selling."**	Stay calm. Don't explain. Ask for the right person.	**Like a family selling their house.** They don't tell the helpers first. Owner plans can be private, even from staff.
	Sample: "Understood. It's about [Owner]'s practice, and it's best discussed with [Owner] directly. Could you put me through, please? Thank you."		
25	**"Talk to our operations manager."**	Be polite. See if they can help you reach the owner.	**Like being sent to a different window.** They may not decide, but they may walk you to the right door.
	Sample: "Thank you. What's the best way for me to reach [Owner] directly?"		

E Rules and restrictions

Follow their rules, then ask for another way to reach the owner.

#	Situation	Goal	Why it works
26	**"No unsolicited calls. Remove us."**	Exit politely. Mark Do Not Call in GHL right away.	**Like a "No Solicitors" sign.** Respecting it protects the company's reputation.
	Sample: "Of course. I'll make sure your number is removed. Thank you for your time."		
27	**"Calls are recorded. They can't discuss this here."**	Respect it. Ask for an email or a better number.	**Like a bank full of CCTV.** You don't argue with the rules. You ask to talk somewhere better.
	Sample: "I understand. What's the best direct number or email for [Owner]?"		
28	**"Compliance has to approve this."**	Learn their process.	**Like getting a permit.** Go to the right window and things move faster.
	Sample: "That makes sense. Who should I send information to for review?"		
29	**"Our broker-dealer doesn't allow these calls."**	Stay respectful. Never comment on their agreements.	**Like someone's work contract.** You're not their lawyer. That's for the principals.
	Sample: "Understood, I respect that. How does [Owner] prefer to be contacted?"		

F Phone systems and wrong contacts

#	Situation	Goal	Why it works
30	**Phone menu (IVR)**	Reach a real person. Directory first, then the operator or front desk.	**Like a mall directory.** Look up the store instead of walking every floor. Note what worked in GHL.
	Tip: Search the directory by the owner's last name. If there's none, press 0 or choose the operator or front desk option.		
31	**"No one here by that name."**	Ask who owns the firm now. Update GHL.	**Like an old address on a package.** Fix it, or the next delivery fails too.
	Sample: "I may have outdated information. Who owns the firm now?"		
32	**"They retired / left the firm."**	Find the new owner. Update GHL.	**Like a restaurant with a new owner.** New leadership often means new plans.
	Sample: "Thank you for letting me know. Who leads the firm now?"		
33	**"They passed away."**	Offer condolences and end the call. Note it in GHL.	**Like visiting during a wake.** You show respect and leave. Never pitch.
	Sample: "I'm very sorry to hear that. Thank you for telling me, and I apologize for the call."		

G Other situations

#	Situation	Goal	Why it works
34	**A chatty, friendly gatekeeper**	Build rapport. Learn the owner's schedule.	**Like the friendly tita at the sari-sari store** who tells you when the owner drops by.
	Sample: "Thanks so much, [Gatekeeper]! When is usually the best time to catch [Owner]?"		
35	**A rude gatekeeper, or they hang up**	Stay professional. Try another day.	**Like a grumpy jeepney driver.** Their bad day, not yours.
	Sample: "Thank you for your time." Then log it and try again another day.		
36	**"Can you hold?" (long hold)**	Keep the call. Get ready while waiting.	**Like a bank line.** Fill out your form while waiting so you're ready when called.
	Sample: "Sure, I'll hold. Thank you." If the hold is long: "I don't want to keep you waiting. What time today is best to reach [Owner]?"		
37	**Third callback, same gatekeeper**	Use their name. Mention the last call.	**Like the guard who now greets you by name.** Being polite and consistent builds familiarity.
	Sample: "Hi [Gatekeeper], it's [Your name] from One Wealth Map again, calling for [Owner]. Could you put me through, please? Thank you."		
38	**You get cut off mid-sentence**	Finish your point calmly, then redirect.	**Like a jeepney stopping short of your stop.** You still say "para po" and get off where you need to.
	Sample: "Sorry, just to finish: I'm calling on behalf of our founder, Ken Himmler, about [Owner]'s practice. Could you put me through, please? Thank you."		
39	**The owner answers directly**	Switch to owner mode right away.	**Like the boss walking past you in the lobby.** Don't freeze. Greet them and introduce yourself.
	Sample: "Hi [Owner], this is [Your name] from One Wealth Map. Thanks for taking my call. I'll be quick. I'm calling on behalf of our founder, Ken Himmler. We're talking with a few firm owners to understand what's next for their practice. So I'm curious: when you think about your practice five years from now, do you see yourself still running it, handing it over, or already retired?"		

H When you reach the owner

If the owner is still on the line, you still have a chance to ask a question.

Acknowledge
And mean it
→
One question
About their future
→
Listen
Find the path
→
Ask
For a specific day and time

Don't ask permission to talk. Skip "Do you have two minutes?" and "Can I ask you a quick question?" Say "Thanks for taking my call. I'll be quick," then ask your question. **Ask before you pitch:** their answer tells you what to say. **Avoid words that invite a no:** "If you're interested," "Would it be worth...," "Would you be open to hearing about...," "What isn't working?" and "What's holding back your growth?"

#	Situation	Goal	Why it works
40	**"I'm good." / "We're doing well."**	Agree first. Then ask about more: more clients, more time, more services.	**Like a healthy person and a check-up.** Doing well is a good time to plan. A question about "more" keeps the talk going.
	Sample: "That's great to hear. Out of curiosity, how many more clients could you take on right now?"		
41	**"I'm busy."**	Respect it, but keep going with one question. Don't offer to call back unless they truly can't talk.	**Like an elevator ride.** You get one floor's worth of time. Keep it brief and get to the point.
	Sample: "I understand. I'll be quick. Just one thing: [ask your next question]." (Offer a callback only if they truly can't talk.)		
42	**"Just send me information."**	Agree, then ask one open question before you send it.	**Like flyers in your own inbox.** Not all of them get read. Sometimes "send info" is a polite way to end the call.
	Sample: "Sure, I'll send it. So I send the right information, what are you focused on with your practice right now?"		
43	**"Not interested" right after your intro**	Don't pitch. Ask what they're focused on, and listen.	**Like a doctor asking questions before giving medicine.** You can't help until you know where they are. Their answer tells you what to say next.
	Sample: "I understand. What are you focused on right now with your practice? Keeping what you've built, or growing it?"		
44	**"What is this about?" from the owner**	Clear purpose in one line, then a question.	**Like a doctor explaining before an exam.** People relax when they know why you're there.
	Sample: I'm calling on behalf of our founder, Ken Himmler. We're talking with a few firm owners to understand what's next for their practice. So I'm curious: when you think about your practice five years from now, do you see yourself still running it, handing it over, or already retired?		

#	Situation	Goal	Why it works
45	**"Never heard of you." / "You're small."**	Agree, then build up the founder with approved facts.	**Like a new restaurant by an experienced chef.** People try it because of the chef's background.
	Sample: That's fair. We're at about $300 million, and we're growing about 40% a year. Our founder has built and sold a few firms, so he's been on both sides of these conversations. Are you free [day] at [time], or would [time] work better?		
46	**They say yes but "I'll book it later."**	Offer two specific times now.	**Like "let's hang out sometime."** Without a date, it is easy to forget.
	Sample: If it's easier, we can pick a time now so it's on your calendar. Would Tuesday at 10 AM or Thursday at 2 PM your time work better?		
47	**"What's in it for me?" / "What are these questions for?"**	Explain the purpose of the call in plain words. Then give two times.	**Like asking why the doctor needs your history.** Once people know why you're asking, they relax and answer.
	Sample: Fair question. Ken has built and sold a few firms, so he's been on your side of these decisions. The call is to understand where you want your practice to go, and to show you options that could fit. There's no commitment. Are you free [day] at [time], or would [time] work better?		
48	**"I don't want to share that."**	Respect it. Then ask an easier question.	**Like a shy patient.** You don't push. You ask something easier, and they open up.
	Sample: "That's fair, no problem. Then just one thing: how many more clients could you take on right now?"		
49	**"Do I need to pay anything?"**	Answer clearly and quickly.	**Like a free first consultation.** A clear "no cost" removes the worry.
	Sample: No, there's no cost. The call is free and confidential.		
50	**"I have to go."**	Get their direct number before they hang up.	**Like a friend leaving the party.** You get their number before they walk out, not after.
	Sample: "Of course. Before you go, what's the best number to reach you directly? I'll call you back tomorrow at [time]."		

Remember

Acknowledge first. Say it warmly so it sounds sincere. **End with a question,** so the conversation keeps going.

PRACTICE Write your own lines

Write how you would say each one. Then practice saying them out loud.

Moment	My words
My opening to a gatekeeper	
"What's this regarding?"	
"Is this a sales call?"	
"Is [Owner] expecting your call?"	
"They're not available."	
Owner: "I'm good."	
Owner: "Not interested."	
My ask for the meeting	

CHECKLIST Before you hang up

- ☐ Did I use first names?
- ☐ Was my answer short?
- ☐ Did I avoid pitch and trigger words?
- ☐ Did I end with a request or open question?

- ☐ Did everything I say stay true?
- ☐ Did I get a direct line, time or email?
- ☐ Did I say please and thank you?
- ☐ Did I log it in GHL?